



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cameroon: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 21 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Cabinet reviewed the national artificial-intelligence strategy on 30 July and was told it is [still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) – a year after a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars was presented. The same session recorded Cameroon as a [founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#), with no accession date published.

Payments moved regionally rather than nationally: an [interoperable QR-code standard launched at Douala on 29 July](#), and the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system on 9 July](#).

The data-protection authority's position was restated and did not change: [created in law, not established, and carrying no appropriation in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates](#).

Infrastructure

An account of 27 July put the national fibre backbone at [over 15,000 km](#), against about 12,000 km terrestrial on the 2024 reference year; the two figures are not reconciled to a single primary and may rest on different measurement bases.

The same account records the [2024 customs circular on satellite terminals still operative](#), with kits entering through indirect registration abroad and ten modems seized at one post in December 2025.

Digital public infrastructure

Two identity operations ran in the month, both municipal. On 27 July [4,000 free identity cards were handed over at Yaoundé 5](#), some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site; the operation was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. From 3 July, [compulsory registration of taxi owners and drivers opened on a city platform](#), with a QR code and a unique door number per driver and unregistered taxis barred after 5 October.

The [national civil-status registry platform](#) was reported deployed in pilot councils on 16 July; the source names no councils and gives no target. The same seminar put council digitisation at [230 councils](#), about [64% nationally](#), with [48.6% of North West councils operating functional websites](#), [335 municipal portals developed](#) and [145 authorities equipped](#).

Payments had the month's densest run. On 9 July the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system](#), [extending it to all six member states and 72m people](#), with member-state banks to be integrated by end-2026; no Cameroonian bank is yet named as live on it. On 29 July an [interoperable QR-code standard launched under a regional regulation of 8 April](#), letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six states. A day later a [consultation opened on revising the switch's tariff grid](#), the operator conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments; no revised grid or effective date is published.

On 29 July a joint communiqué [established a trilateral customs steering committee with Nigeria and Benin](#), committing to harmonised procedures, digital interoperability and coordinated risk management on two named corridors, with no timeline, budget or system specification published.

Governance and regulation

The personal data protection authority's position was restated on 29 July and is unchanged: [created in law by the 2024 statute](#), [not established](#), and [unfunded](#), with [no appropriation in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates](#). The statute defines it as an independent public body, so the function does not sit with the ICT agency, and its only appearance in a finance law is a tax derogation from it.

An account of 27 July set out where the satellite licence stands: a [draft concession convention and specification finalised by the regulator](#), the [file at the ministry undecided for more than two years](#), and the [2024 seizure circular still operative](#). The objections on record are lawful interception, armed-group use, and the incumbent's commercial position.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Cabinet was told on 30 July that the [national AI strategy is still being developed](#), with [ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) and no adoption instrument published; a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars had been presented in July 2025. The [AI authority and presidential council that roadmap provided for remain uncreated](#) and are absent from the ten priorities, which carry only adaptation of the legal framework. Among the priorities is a [national high-performance computing centre](#), announced with no site, cost, operator or timetable. At the same session the telecommunications minister said Cameroon had [acceded as a founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#); the accession date is not published.

On 8 July the state operator held a [working session with a global cloud vendor's Africa executives and the United States embassy ICT representative](#). It is [talks only](#): no agreement, investment commitment, timeline, or answer on [where Cameroonian data would sit](#), and it sits against the operator's own sovereign-cloud line and a regional data-residency recommendation.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The AI workforce target was carried into the same cabinet review without moving: [60,000 specialists by 2040 including 40% women](#) was set in July 2025, and a year later [AI modules in curricula appear among ten priorities with a roadmap tabled but no adoption, budget line or trainee count](#). Two research builds were tabled in the same list — a [sovereign scientific database on a dedicated national platform](#) and a [centre for the digitisation of scientific and technical information](#) — with no cost, site or timeline for either.

What was delivered was smaller and dated. A first implementation wave under an operator and higher-education memorandum [opened 115 internships across all ten regions on 22 July](#), in disciplines from telecommunications and cybersecurity to finance and law; no stipend, duration or conversion-to-employment figure is published.

A digital financial-literacy project running in Cameroon and Senegal since June 2024 [closed on 15 July](#), leaving a digital financial-services comparison platform with no funded data-update mechanism; it was offered to both states and neither is reported as having accepted. No Cameroon-side trainee count, budget share or partner list is published.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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